

Appendix A

List of Knowledge Indices and Items

UK (EU)

(All questions are true/false)

1. EU has recently expanded to 15 members (true)
2. Switzerland is to join EU (false)
3. Britain's income tax rates are decided in Brussels (false)
4. Elections to European Parliament are held every 5 years
5. Of the three British parties, Liberal Democrats least in favour of EU. (false)

UK (Health)

(All questions are true/false)

1. Standard charge for NHS prescription is 10 pounds (false)
2. Proportion of old people in Britain getting larger (true)
3. Even with inflation taken into account, spending on NHS doubled over last 20 years (true)
4. Most people use private medical treatment instead of NHS (false)
5. All British women get free breast cancer screening on NHS (false)
6. Cosmetic surgery is never available on NHS (false)

UK (GE)

(First three questions are true/false. Others are party placement on a 7 point scale.)

1. Inflation has been less than 5% over the past few years (true).
2. Interest rates are decided by Bank of England (false).
3. Unemployment in UK is higher than in Germany (false).
4. (Conservative, Labor, Liberal Democrat) Party's View: Government should do nothing to make incomes in Britain more equal.
5. (Conservative, Labor, Liberal Democrat) Party's View: Government should spend much less on services like education and health in order to cut taxes a lot.
6. (Conservative, Labor, Liberal Democrat) Party's View: Government should definitely not introduce a minimum wage because too many low paid workers would then lose their jobs.
7. (Conservative, Labor, Liberal Democrat) Party's View: Britain should do much more to keep its distance from the European Union.

UK (Crime)

(All questions are true/false)

Issue Related Items -

1. British courts are allowed to sentence a murderer to death (false).
2. Britain has largest prison population in Western Europe (true).

3. Britain has more people serving life sentences than rest of European Community put together (false).
4. Possible to be tried by jury in local magistrate court (false).

General Politics Items -

1. Number of MPs about 100 (false).
2. Longest time allowed between general elections is 4 years (false).
3. Britain's electoral system is based on proportional representation (false).

UK (Monarchy)

(All questions are true/false)

1. Princess Anne next in line to throne. (false)
2. PM, not the queen, is Britain's Head of State. (false)
3. Queen is head of Commonwealth. (false)
4. Queen's duty to decide election date. (false)
5. No PM takes office without being asked by the Queen. (false)
6. Queen is head of Church of England. (true)
7. Queen is head of Church of Scotland. (false)
8. Britain has unwritten constitution (true).

AU (Monarchy)

Issue Related Items -

1. Which one of these best describes the current role of the Queen in relation to the Australian Governor General? - She chooses the Governor General, She appoints the Governor General only on the advice of the Prime Minister, She appoints the Governor General only on the recommendation of parliament, She has no role in choosing or appointing the Governor General. (She appoints the Governor General only on the advice of the Prime Minister)
2. Which one of these is true of the current role of the Governor-General in Australia – He performs only ceremonial duties, He can decide whether or not to dismiss the government, He acts only on the Queen's instructions, He controls the government. (He performs only ceremonial duties)
3. If the referendum on the republic is passed, which one of these would the role of the President be more like? – The current Governor General, The American President, The British Prime Minister, the current Australian Prime Minister. (The current Governor General)
4. If the referendum on the republic is passed, which one of these best describes how the Australian Prime Minister in the Republic can remove the President? - At any time without reporting to parliament, At any time but must later obtain approval from the House of Representatives, Only after a fair trial in parliament, The Prime Minister could not remove president. (At any time but must later obtain approval from the House of Representatives)
5. Under the proposed change to a Republic, which of these, as far as you know, would definitely change. -
 - a. The Australian Flag (No)

- b. The National Anthem (No)
 - c. The word 'Royal' in the names of the Royal Australian Navy and the Royal Australian Air Force (Yes)
 - d. Australia's participation in the Commonwealth Games (No)
6. On the whole would you say the Liberal Party, or the Labor Party, is more in favour of Australia becoming a Republic?

General Politics Items –

1. Which one of these best describes Aden Ridgeway – Leader of the federal opposition, Leader of the Australian Democrats, An aboriginal senator in parliament, A justice of the high court, Or is he none of these. (An aboriginal senator in parliament)
2. Which one of these best describes Jennie George – A Labor member of federal parliament, Secretary of the Teacher's Federation, President of the ACTU, Leader of the Australian Worker's Union, Or is she none of these. (President of the ACTU)
3. And now about social and welfare issues. On the whole would you say the Liberal Party, or the Labor Party, is more concerned about social and welfare issues, they are equally concerned, or do you not have much of an impression about that? (The Labor Party)
4. And now thinking about business. On the whole would you say the Liberal Party, or the Labor Party, is closer to business, they are equally close or do you not have much of an impression about that? (The Liberal Party)

EU 2007

1. Which of the following countries is an official candidate to join the EU? - Romania, Montenegro, Croatia, Morocco (Croatia)
2. Are the members of the European Parliament – Directly elected by the citizens of their country, Elected for three year terms, Elected by the parliament of their country, Appointed by their national head of government (Directly elected by the citizens of their country)
3. Are new EU laws in the field of employment adopted by - The European Commission, in some cases with the European Parliament, The Council of Ministers, in some cases with the European Parliament, The European Parliament by itself, The European commission by itself (The Council of Ministers, in some cases with the European Parliament)
4. Is the EU's role regarding unemployment benefits to - Finance the member states' unemployment benefit systems, Decide the level and length of unemployment benefits in the member states, Require that the member states merge their unemployment benefit systems by 2010, Guarantee that all EU citizens have access to unemployment benefits where they live (Guarantee that all EU citizens have access to unemployment benefits where they live)
5. Roughly a third of the EU's budget is devoted to one of the following. Is it ... ? - Helping the EU's less prosperous regions, Subsidizing the EU's fishing industry, Financing diplomatic missions abroad, Maintaining the EU's administration and bureaucracy (Helping the EU's less prosperous regions)
6. By 2050, is the percentage of the adult EU population that is 65 or older projected to be - About one quarter of what it is now, About half of what it is now, About the same as

what it is now, About twice what it is now, About four times what it is now (About twice what it is now)

7. Which of the following is true of the amount of foreign aid given by the EU and its member states, combined, versus the amount given by the US? - The EU and its member states give roughly four times as much, The EU and its member states give roughly twice as much, The EU and its member states and the US give about the same amount, The US gives roughly twice as much, The US gives roughly four times as much (The EU and its member states give roughly twice as much)
8. On average, what percentage of the total spending by the governments of the EU member states for foreign aid? Is it - About 1%, About 5%, About 9%, About 13%, About 17% (About 1%)
9. Which of the following countries does NOT possess nuclear weapons? - Pakistan, India, North Korea, Japan (Japan)
10. On a scale from 0 to 10, where 0 means as far left as possible, 10 means as far right as possible, and 5 is exactly in the middle, where would you place –
 - a. Nicholas Sarkozy (Greater than 5)
 - b. Gordon Brown (Less than 5)

New Haven

1. Which of the following would you say is closest to the population of the greater New Haven region? (550,000);
2. During the 1990s, would you say the rate of job growth in the New Haven region was more, about the same, or less than the rest of the United States? (more);
3. Which of the following would you say is the major source of revenue for most town governments in the Greater New Haven region? (Property taxes);
4. Would you say the population of the city of New Haven increased, stayed the same, or decreased during the 1990s? (decreased);
5. Does Connecticut law allow communities to share property tax revenues? (yes);
6. Would you say those communities with the most valuable property tend to have the lowest property tax rates, average property tax rates, or the highest property tax rates? (lowest rates);
7. Which of the following categories would you say the Federal Aviation Authority would use to describe Tweed New Haven Airport? (non-hub);
8. Would you say that maintaining Tweed New Haven Airport at its current level of service would require any significant investment?(yes)

NIC 2

1. Which of the following is closest to what you believe is true about global warming? (Caused by human activities like driving cars and burning fuel);
2. Some people think that global warming is not really a problem so there is no need to do anything about it. Others think it's a serious problem and we need to act now.
 - a. Where would you place the Democratic Party? ("It's a serious problems and we need to act now");
 - b. Where would you place the Republican Party? ("Global warming is not really a problem so there is no need to do anything about it");

3. As far as you know, does President Bush support or oppose recent international agreements to control greenhouse gases, or haven't you heard anything about this? (Oppose);
4. As far as you know, does President Bush want to increase foreign aid, decrease foreign aid, or keep it the same, OR haven't you heard anything about this? (Increase);
5. Out of every \$100 in federal budget, about how many dollars would you say goes to military spending? (\$20);
6. Out of every \$100 in the federal budget, about how many dollars would you say goes to foreign aid? (\$1);
7. For every \$100 in goods & services produced by the US, how many dollars worth would you say are sold to customers abroad? (\$12);
8. In those African countries with the highest rates of infection with the AIDS virus, roughly how many adults out of every 100 would you say have AIDS or the AIDS virus? (30 or more);
9. True or false - "The US has veto on WTO decisions" (False);
10. True or false - "The US has veto on the UNSC" (True)

BTP 2004

1. How did John Kerry vote in the Senate on the resolution authorizing President Bush to go to war with Iraq? (Voted for);
2. Which of the following countries now harbors the most Al Qaeda and Taliban fighters? (Pakistan);
3. True or false - "Iraq was directly involved in the attacks on the WTC and the Pentagon on 9-11 2001" (False);
4. True or false - "Large quantities of weapons of mass destruction have been found in Iraq" (False);
5. True or false - "On average, prescription drugs cost more in Canada than in the US" (False);
6. Which of the following was true of George W. Bush during the Vietnam War? (served in the TX Air National Guard);
7. Which of the following was true of John Kerry during the Vietnam War? (decorated officer serving in Vietnam);
8. A major destination of white collar jobs that have gone to other countries is? (India);
9. Which of the following is closest to the number of Americans killed in Iraq since the war began? (1000)

BTP 2005

1. Among 29 wealthy industrialized nations, does the US rank top 3, top 10, bottom 10, or bottom 3 in students' math skills? (Bottom 10);
2. In the last few years, it has become harder, easier or about the same to obtain US work permits for foreigners. (Harder);
3. In the last few years, "the gap between minority and white students in math and reading tests at the elementary school level" has increased, decreased, or stayed about the same. (Increased);

4. Number of uninsured Americans. Answer choices: 1 million, 25 million, 45 million, 65 million or 85 million.(45 mill);
5. “Over the next fifty years, do you think the number of Americans over age 65 will...?” Answer choices: tripled, doubled, increased by half, or stayed about the same (Doubled);
6. The percentage of uninsured low income families. Answer choices: a quarter, fifty percent, two-thirds, or ninety percent (Two Thirds)

San Mateo

1. According to the Association of Bay Area Governments, between 1999 and 2006, what was the gap each year between the number of new homes needed and the number actually produced in San Mateo County? (About 1000);
2. As of Sept 2007, about how much was the median price of a single-family home in San Mateo County? (\$950,000);
3. As of 2006, about what percentage of Country households could afford a median-priced house in San Mateo County? (12%);
4. As of 2007 what was the average rent for a 2-bedroom apartment in San Mateo County? (\$1700);
5. According to the 2006 San Mateo County Housing Needs Study, by about how many housing units is the demand for housing in San Mateo County projected to grow between 2005 and 2025? (70,000);
6. According to the same Housing Needs Study, among the new households that are expected to form in the County between 2005 and 2025, about what percentage, combined, would be households with low, very low and extremely low-incomes? (About half);
7. According to the 2006 San Mateo County Housing Needs Study, roughly how many new homes (including houses, townhomes, condos, and apartments) will be built between 2005 and 2025 at the current rate of housing development? (25,000);
8. What percentage of San Mateo County's land is agricultural use, watershed, open space, wetlands, or parks? (more than 75%)

Bulgaria

(All of the questions were True or False)

1. If a policeman wants to detain a citizen for questioning at any time of the day or night, the citizen does not have the right to refuse (True)
2. The Court has the right to detain suspects as long as needed to prove if they are guilty or not (False)
3. The prosecution can detain a suspect until the case is resolved (False)
4. The Chief Prosecutor is responsible and accountable to Parliament (True)
5. The police do not have the right to use violence against a detainee even if proven that he/she has committed a crime (False)
6. The police can detain you for 72 hours (False)
7. A confession is not enough to find the defendant guilty (False)

CPL

1. What energy source do you think produces the greatest amount of CPL's electricity; coal, wind, natural gas, fuel oil, nuclear, or solar? (Natural Gas)
2. Overall, what group of CPL customers consume the most kilowatt hours of electricity; residential, commercial, or industrial? (Industrial)
3. Which customer group pays the highest electric rates; residential, commercial, or industrial? (Commercial)
4. Which of the following resources used to produce electricity produces the most air emissions; nuclear, coal, or natural gas? (Coal)
5. Roughly, how much profit do Texas electric utilities make on fuel; 0%, 10%, 20%, or 30%? (0%)
6. Which agency sets electric rates in Texas? – PUC, Texas Utility Commission, Government, CPL, WT, SWEPCO, Other. (PUC)
7. How much of your electric bill goes for fuel; less than 20%, 21 to 30%, 31 to 40%, 41 to 50%, or more than 50%? (21 – 30%)

SWEPCO

1. What energy source do you think produces the greatest amount of SWEPCO's electricity; coal, wind, natural gas, fuel oil, nuclear, or solar? (coal)
2. Overall, what group of SWEPCO customers consume the most kilowatt hours of electricity; residential, commercial, or industrial? (industrial)
3. Which customer group pays the highest electric rates; residential, commercial, or industrial? (residential)
4. Which of the following resources used to produce electricity produces the most air emissions; nuclear, coal, or natural gas? (coal)
5. Which agency sets electric rates in Texas? - PUC, Texas Utility Commission, Government, CPL, WT, SWEPCO, Other. (PUC)

WTU

1. What energy source do you think produces the greatest amount of WTU's electricity; coal, wind, natural gas, fuel oil, nuclear, or solar? (natural gas)
2. Overall, what group of WTU customers consume the most kilowatt hours of electricity; residential, commercial, or industrial? (residential)
3. Which customer group pays the highest electric rates; residential, commercial, or industrial? (residential)
4. Which of the following resources used to produce electricity produces the most air emissions; nuclear, coal, or natural gas? (coal)
5. Which agency sets electric rates in Texas? - PUC, Texas Utility Commission, Government, CPL, WT, SWEPCO, Other. (PUC)

China (Zeguo)

1. Has Zeguo Township's revenue increased by 10.2 per cent, 20.1 per cent, 33.7 per cent, or not at all between 2003 and 2004. (33.7 percent)
2. Zeguo Township's floating population is 50,000, 120,000, 200,000 or 300,000? (120,000)

3. Are any of the following (water pumps, shoes, plastic products, or air compressors) not a major product of the township? (plastic products)
4. The township has zero, one, two, five or seven parks? (two)